Competitor watch · Q2 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison: listed companies

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**H1 2026 results (6 months)**	**1,560 EUR**	**+0.2%**	**+5.0%**	**14.4%**	**+90 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	H1 2026 results (6 months)	1,159 GBP	+6.0%	+5.0%	18.7%	+50 bps	Adj. operating margin
Belimo	H1 2026 results (6 months)	676.4 CHF	+20.5%	+29.6%	22.5%	−30 bps	EBIT margin
Xylem	Q2 2026 results	2,336 USD	+1.5%	+1.0%	23.3%	+150 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q2 2026 results	4,415 USD	+9.7%	+5.0%	18.8%	+40 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	Q2 2026 results	763.2 USD	+18.6%	+12.2%	21.0%	−60 bps	Adj. operating margin
Emerson[1]	Q2 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Mar 2026)	4,562 USD	+2.9%	+0.5%	27.6%	−40 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q2 2026 results	932.6 USD	−17.0%	−17.3%	25.4%	−100 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	H1 2026 results (6 months)	1,696 CHF	−24.8%	+5.7%	13.4%		Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions
Danfoss[2]	H1 2026 results (6 months)	5,254 EUR	+11.7%	+15.0%	15.3%	+350 bps	Operational EBITA margin

Organic growth by quarter

Company	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025	FY 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026
Aalberts	**−3.3%**	**−3.2%**	**−1.9%**	**−2.5%**	**+2.8%**	**+5.0%**	**+13.0%**
IMI	−3.0%	+2.0%	+12.0%	+5.0%	+5.0%	+5.0%	+2.0%
Belimo	–	+20.6%	–	+23.3%	–	+29.6%	–
Xylem	+3.0%	+6.0%	+7.0%	+5.0%	0.0%	+1.0%	0.0%
Ecolab	+3.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+4.0%	+5.0%	+7.0%
Watts	−2.1%	+5.8%	+9.4%	+5.3%	+11.9%	+12.2%	due
Emerson[1]	+2.0%	+2.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+2.0%	+0.5%	+6.0%
Pentair	−0.8%	+1.3%	+3.3%	–	+1.1%	−17.3%	−5.0%
Georg Fischer	–	+0.1%	–	−1.7%	–	+5.7%	–
Danfoss[2]	–	−3.0%	–	+3.0%	–	+15.0%	–

Notes: organic growth as each company defines it.

Reported margin by quarter

Company	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025	FY 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Margin measure
Aalberts	**13.6%** **−60 bps**	**13.5%** **−150 bps**	**12.5%** **−120 bps**	**13.2%** **−180 bps**	**14.2%** **+60 bps**	**14.4%** **+90 bps**	**13.8%** **+130 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	–	18.2% +30 bps	–	20.0% +30 bps	–	18.7% +50 bps	–	Adj. operating margin
Belimo	–	22.8% +320 bps	–	20.8% +159 bps	–	22.5% −30 bps	–	EBIT margin
Xylem	20.4% +120 bps	21.8% +100 bps	23.2% +200 bps	22.2% +160 bps	20.6% +20 bps	23.3% +150 bps	23.9% +70 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	16.0% +190 bps	18.3% +170 bps	18.7% +110 bps	17.9% +150 bps	16.7% +70 bps	18.8% +40 bps	19.6% +70 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	19.0%	21.6%	18.5% +140 bps	19.6% +190 bps	20.1% +110 bps	21.0% −60 bps	due	Adj. operating margin
Emerson[1]	28.0% +340 bps	28.0% +200 bps	27.1% 0 bps	27.6% +160 bps	27.7% −30 bps	27.6% −40 bps	28.5% +140 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	24.0%	26.4%	25.7%	–	25.0% +100 bps	25.4% −100 bps	24.8% −90 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	–	10.4% −130 bps	–	11.4% −150 bps	–	13.4%	–	Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions
Danfoss[2]	–	10.6% −90 bps	–	12.9% +40 bps	–	15.3% +350 bps	–	Operational EBITA margin

Notes: [1] Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them. [2] Danfoss is not listed on a stock exchange (owned by the Danfoss family and the Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation), so it has no share price; it is included because it publishes audited financial results, half-year and full-year only.

Key messages: listed companies · Q2 2026

1. Overall performance

- **Aalberts**: revenue **1,560** EUR m (+0.2%), organic **+5.0%**, EBITA margin **14.4%** +90 bps. All segments grew organically and improved margins.
- **IMI**: revenue **1,159** GBP m (+6.0%), organic **+5.0%**, Adj. operating margin **18.7%** +50 bps. Automation margin +100 bps to 19.4% on operating leverage and Process Automation aftermarket mix
- **Belimo**: revenue **676.4** CHF m (+20.5%), organic **+29.6%**, EBIT margin **22.5%** −30 bps. Data centres ~23–24% of sales (~18% in H2 2025), mostly liquid cooling.
- **Xylem**: revenue **2,336** USD m (+1.5%), organic **+1.0%**, Adj. EBITDA margin **23.3%** +150 bps. Orders +41% organic on a WSS outsourced-water surge (+147%) and AW data-centre wins.
- **Ecolab**: revenue **4,415** USD m (+9.7%), organic **+5.0%**, Organic operating margin **18.8%** +40 bps. Organic growth accelerated to 5%: High-Tech +29% organic, Life Sciences +15%, Pest +7%, Water +4%.
- **Watts**: revenue **763.2** USD m (+18.6%), organic **+12.2%**, Adj. operating margin **21.0%** −60 bps. Adj. operating margin 21.0% (−60 bps) on acquisition dilution and a one-off price/cost benefit last year; price added ~6%.
- **Emerson**[1]: revenue **4,562** USD m (+2.9%), organic **+0.5%**, Adj. segment EBITA margin **27.6%** −40 bps. Underlying +0.5%: price +3.5% but volume −3% from software-renewal timing (−2 pts) and the Middle East conflict (−1 pt).
- **Pentair**: revenue **932.6** USD m (−17.0%), organic **−17.3%**, Adj. return on sales **25.4%** −100 bps. Pool core −42.4% on the channel destock, segment income −62%.
- **Georg Fischer**: revenue **1,696** CHF m (−24.8%), organic **+5.7%**, Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions **13.4%** . Comparable EBITDA margin 13.4%, comparable EBIT margin 10.0%.
- **Danfoss**[2]: revenue **5,254** EUR m (+11.7%), organic **+15.0%**, Operational EBITA margin **15.3%** +350 bps. Operational EBITA EUR 802m (+44%), margin 15.3% (+3.5 pts); net profit EUR 436m (269m); free operating cash flow after financial items and tax EUR 164m (−168m).

2. M&A moves

- **Belimo**: No acquisitions or disposals found for 2026; growth is organic, backed by capacity investment.
- **Watts**: Acquisitions added USD 34m of revenue in Q2 (5 pts of growth)
- **Georg Fischer**: Majority of GF Casting Solutions sold in February 2026
- **Danfoss**[2]: Bought the remaining 38% of Semikron Danfoss (power semiconductors) in Q1 2026, now 100% owned.

3. Operations, innovation and production

- **Belimo**: Capacity: new production and logistics building in Hinwil (CH) opened Aug 2026; 170,000 sq ft warehouse in Stratford, CT
- **Watts**: Data centre sales more than tripled to ~8% of H1 sales, driven by the newly launched CoolVault thermal storage tanks.
- **Georg Fischer**: Net debt CHF 1,684m at end-2025 after the transformation
- **Danfoss**[2]: Data centres drive growth in all three segments: air- and liquid-cooling, power conversion, energy storage and heat recovery for hyperscalers and chip makers.

Sources: each company's report for the period.

Other key competitors · Q2 2026

Private companies and divisions, by relevance to HFC.

Company (relevance)	Performance	M&A	Operations
Caleffi very high (5/5)			Logistics automation (SSI Schäfer) at Fontaneto d'Agogna and Gattico-Veruno: >7,000 catalogue codes and >40 million products made per year (case study, Apr 2026).
Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) very high (5/5)			Opened a new production site for heating and cooling storage tanks in Rimavská Sobota, Slovakia (17 Jun 2026), Winkelmann's largest single investment; workforce to grow by ~450 from 2026.
Grundfos high (4/5)	H1 2026: sales +7.7% in local currency to DKK 17.9bn		Broke ground (24 Jun 2026) on a ~143,000 sq ft manufacturing expansion at its US headquarters campus in Brookshire, Texas, completion Q3 2027; efficiency programmes at plants in Mexico and Hungary.
Oventrop high (4/5)			IG Metall called a two-hour warning strike at Brilon (20 May 2026) to push for a social collective agreement over the move of assembly to Poland
Spirotech high (4/5)			Signed the construction contract for a new headquarters in Helmond (8 May 2026); construction Aug 2026 – Oct 2027, described as the basis for further growth. With SCHÄFER IT-Systems, launched ProtectaCool Rack (Apr 2026): water treatment, pressure maintenance, degassing and dirt/magnetite separation integrated in a server rack for direct liquid cooling in data centres; first shown at Data Centre World Frankfurt (6–7 May).
ESBE moderate (3/5)			Invested in a transfer machine for lead-free brass, bringing more production back to Sweden (Jun 2026); named one of Sweden's best-managed companies (May 2026).
Fernox moderate (3/5)			Launched an enhanced commercial water-treatment range, shown at InstallerSHOW 2026 (Jun 2026).
Siemens Smart Infrastructure[1] moderate (3/5)	Fiscal Q2 2026: revenue ~EUR 5.9bn, profit EUR 1.1bn (18.6%); record data-centre orders EUR 1.9bn		
Alfa Laval low (2/5)	Q2 2026: order intake SEK 22.2bn (+29% organic), net sales SEK 18.1bn, adj. EBITA margin 17.0% (17.8%).		
Resideo (Honeywell Home) low (2/5)	Q2 2026: revenue ~USD 1.98bn (+2%), Products & Solutions +4%; input-cost pressure (memory, metals, PCBs) expected to peak in Q3.		
Victaulic low (2/5)			Marked 100 years since its first mechanical pipe-joining patent (4 Apr 2026); 309,000 sq ft distribution centre in Halfway, Maryland due to open in H1 2026.

Notes: [1] Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them.